Yen-Chieh (David) Liao

Division of Mainland China and East Asian Studies | Graduate Institute of National Development
National Taiwan University
davidycliao@gmail.com davidycliao davidycliao.github.io | *Updated:* Aug. 15, 2026

ACADEMIC POSITIONS

National Taiwan University

Assistant Professor, Graduate Institute of National Development (MA and PhD Programs) Aug 2026 – Present

University of Birmingham

Research Fellow in NLP at the Centre for Artificial Intelligence in Government Sep 2024 – July 2026

Affiliate Fellow at the Institute for Data and AI Jul 2025 – July 2026

University College Dublin

Post-doctoral Researcher at the School of Politics and International Relations Aug 2023 – Sep 2024

University of Bamberg

Pre-doctoral Researcher at the Chair of Comparative Politics Dec 2021 – Dec 2022

EDUCATION

University of Essex

PhD in Politics Oct 2017 – Jan 2023

National Taipei University

BA and MA in Public Administration and Policy

RESEARCH

2026 Electoral Systems and Geographically-Targeted Oversight: Evidence from Taiwan Legislative Yuan. (with Li Tang) ***Electoral Studies*** [DOI: https://doi.org/10.1016/j.electstud.2025.103026].

2025 Catalysts for Progress? Mapping Policy Insights from Energy Research. ***Energy Research and Social Science***. (with Brian Boyle, Stefan Müller, Sarah King and Robin Rauner) [DOI: https://doi.org/10.1016/j.erss.2025.103955]

2025 Bureaucratic Reinterpretation of Leaders' Ideologies: A Case Study of People's Daily's Commentary on Xi Jinping Thought on Diplomacy (in Chinese). ***Mainland China Studies***. (with Yi-Nung Tsai) [https://doi.org/10.30389/MCS.202503_68(1).0003]

2024 (Mis)perception of Party-voter Congruence and Satisfaction with Democracy. ***Political Science Research and Methods***. (with Li Tang and Royce Carroll) [DOI: https://doi.org/10.1017/psrm.2024.48]

2024 Electoral Reform and Fragmented Polarization: New Evidence from Taiwan Legislative Roll Calls. ***Legislative Studies Quarterly*** [DOI:https://doi.org/10.1111/lsq.12459]

2023 The Role of Rituals in Adversarial Parliaments: An Analysis of Expressions of Collegiality in the British House of Commons. (Invited Contribution) ***Historical Social Research***. 48 (3): 209-234. (with David Beck and Thomas Saalfeld) [DOI: https://doi.org/10.12759/hsr.48.2023.31]

2015 The Rationale for Supporting Nuclear Power: Analysis of Taiwanese Public Opinion Survey. ***International Relations of the Asia-Pacific***. 15 (1): 147–176. (with Xiaochen Su, Chung-li Wu, Tai-De Lee, and Chen Tsao)[DOI: https://doi.org/10.1093/irap/lcu019]

Selected Working Papers

Electoral Reform and Issue Attention in Legislative Oversight: From SNTV to Mixed-Member Majoritarian System in Taiwan. (with Yu-Ceng Liao and Yi-ting Wang) ***Revise and Resubmit at Electoral Studies***.

Knocking on the Wrong Door: Partisan Canvassing and Asymmetric Belief Updating in Britain. (with Li Tang) **Under review**

AI Survey Respondents as Measurement Instruments: A Pre-Registered Total Survey Error Framework. (with Linette Lim and Slava Jankin) ***Revise and Resubmit at Public Opinion Quarterly***

Cross-Lingual Stance Detection in Political Texts: Comparison and Application. (with Stefan Müller) **Under review**

ACADEMIC TRAINING PROGRAMMES

2024 ***ARCHER2 Message Passing Programming with MPI (Edinburgh Parallel Computing Centre)***

2023 ***Oxford Large Language Models for Social Science Workshop*** | **57thEssex Summer School:** Advanced Survey Data Analysis and Survey Experiments

2022 ***56th Essex Summer School,*** Introduction to Social Network Analysis

2021 ***Machine Learning Summer School:*** Standard Training Programme | ***55th Essex Summer School:*** Advanced Methods for Text-as-Data–Natural Language Processing; Quantitative Methods for Causal Inference and Policy Evaluation

2019 ***54th Essex Summer School:*** Introduction to Bayesian Analysis for the Social Sciences

2018 ***53rd Essex Summer School:*** Ideal Point Estimation and Scaling Methods; Generalized Linear Models

CODE & OPEN-SOURCE PACKAGES

flaiR: An R wrapper for accessing the Flair NLP library in Python.

legisTaiwan: An R package for accessing real-time Taiwan Legislative Data.

asmcjr: An R Package for Supporting the Book 'Analyzing Spatial Models of Choice and Judgment.

TEACHING & SUPERVISION

University of Birmingham MSc Supervision

2024-05 Florida Ferizolli (MSc in AI and Government) | Jiaqi Liu (MSc in AI and Sustainable Development,)

Course and Module

2024 ***University College Dublin*** Quantitative Text Analysis (Led by Stefan Müller)

Guest Lecturer in Weeks on Word Embeddings and Transformers

Invited Talks

2025 ***Centre of Taiwan Studies, SOAS***

Taiwan's Electoral System & Legislative Behaviour

2025 ***Taipei R LADIES***

Data Analysis and Applications with **legisTaiwan** and Taiwan Legislative Yuan API.

2024 ***SPIRe PhD Workshop, University College Dublin***

Introduction to High-Performance Computing with SLURM

Teaching and Workshops

2023 ***GESIS Fall Seminar in Computational Social Science***

Instructor in Big Data and Computation for Social Data Science (Co-lecturing with Akitaka Matsuo)

2022 ***55th Essex Summer School***

Teaching Assistant for Iulia Cioroianu — Course: Quantitative Text Analysis

Teaching Assistant for Akitaka Matsuo — Course: Introduction to Programming in Python

2021 ***54th Essex Summer School***

Teaching Assistant for Johannes Karreth — Course: Introduction to Quantitative Methods in R

2021 ***EITM Europe Summer Institute***

Teaching Assistant for Ken Benoit and Nicole Baerg — Course: Quantitative Text Analysis

2020 ***53rd Essex Summer School***

Teaching Assistant for Iulia Cioroianu — Course: Quantitative Text Analysis

2020 ***ECPR Summer School***

Teaching Assistant for Akitaka Matsuo - Course: Machine Learning with Big Data for Social Scientists

2019 ***53rd Essex Summer School***

Teaching Assistant for Iulia Cioroianu — Course: Quantitative Text Analysis

RESEARCH GRANTS & AWARD

2025 APSA First Generation Scholars Travel Grant Award

2023 The Scholarship for Attending Oxford Large Language Models for Social Science Workshop, £300

2021–22 Taiwan Overseas Pioneers Grants of Ministry of Science and Technology Taiwan, USD$32,000

2022 University of Essex Departmental Fund for attending 2022 MPSA, £900

2019 University of Essex Departmental Fund for attending 2019 EPSA, £450

2018 Attendance Scholarships to Essex Summer School in Social Science Data Analysis, £250

2017–21 The Government Doctoral Scholarship in Legislative Studies and Comparative Politics, Taiwan's Ministry of Education USD$168,000

JOURNAL REFEREE SERVICE

European Journal of Political Research x 2; *Political Science Review* x 3; *Political Science Research and Methods* x 3; *Journal of Taiwan Politics* x 1; *Legislative Studies Quarterly* x 5; *Government and Opposition* x 1; *Electoral Studies* x 4; *Representation* x 2; *Journal of Politics* x 1, *Research & Politics* x 2, *The Social Science Journal* x 1

CONFERENCES (*: discussant; +: Poster)

2026 PolMeth Europe (TCD) | APSA* (Boston) | EPSS (Belfast)

2025 PolMeth Europe (LSE) | PolMeth+ (Emory) | APSA* (Vacouver) | EPSA* (Madrid)

2024 COMPTEXT (Amsterdam) | EPSA (Cologne) | APSA* (Philadelphia)

2023 EPSA (Glasgow) | APSA* (LA) | ECPR SG Parliaments (Vienna)

2022 ECPR (Innsbruck) | PolMeth+ (WashU) | COMPTEXT (Dublin)

2021 MLSS+ (NTU, Taiwan) | APSA (Online)

2019 EPSA (Online) | Asian PolMeth+ (Online)

2018 EPSA (Belfast)

REFERENCES

Prof. Slava Jankin
Chair in Data Science and Government
University of Birmingham
sjankin.com

Prof. Thomas Saalfeld
Chair of Comparative Politics
University of Bamberg
uni-bamberg.de

Prof. Stefan Müller
School of Politics and International Relations
University College Dublin
muellerstefan.net

Prof. Royce Carroll
Department of Political Science
University of Houston
scholar.google